RUBIAT SAIMUM

Department of Political Studies
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Education

PhD Student, Department of Political Studies, Queen's University, Canada (GPA: 3.95/4.00) *2025–2029*

Master of Arts in Political Science, Department of Political Science, Memorial University of Newfoundland (GPA: 4.00/4.00) *2023–2025*

Master of Social Sciences in International Relations, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka

Bachelor of Social Sciences in International Relations, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka

Research and Professional Experience

Centre for International and Defence Policy *September 2025–Present*
Researcher

Population and Security (blog) *October 2024–*
Assistant Managing Editor *August 2025*

Memorial University of Newfoundland *September 2023–*
Graduate Assistant (GA) *August 2025*
Research Assistant to Dr. Isabelle Côté on the SSHRC-funded projects *Internal Migration and Nativism in Federal States* and *"My Roots, My Rights": Opposition to Internal Migration in Multinational States*. Designed a coding scheme and coded over 900 news articles on nativist discourse.

Bangladesh Maritime University (BMU)
Lecturer, Department of Maritime Security and Strategic Studies (MSSS) *October 2021–August 2023*
Assistant Director, International Cooperation and Exchange Office *April 2023–August 2023*

Bangladesh Institute of Maritime Research and Development (BIMRAD) *October 2019–*
Research Officer *September 2021*

Teaching Experience

Queen's University, Department of Political Studies *September 2025–Present*
Course Coordinator and Teaching Assistant, POLS 111/112

Bangladesh Maritime University (BMU), Department of Maritime Security and Strategic Studies (MSSS) *October 2021–August 2023*
Lecturer
Courses taught: M 103: Ocean Affairs and Geopolitics; MDSS 524: International Security

Research Fellowships and Affiliations

YCAPS–East-West Center *October 2024–May 2025*
Maritime GENIE

NATO Association of Canada *April 2024–June 2025*
Junior Fellow, NATO and Indo-Pacific Program

Council for Strategic and Defence Research *October 2023–*
South Asian Futures Fellow *October 2024*

Pacific Forum *June 2022–Present*
Young Leader

Daniel K. Inouye Asia-Pacific Center for Security Studies *2021*
Fellow

Awards and Funding

Queen's Graduate Award (QGA), Queen's University *2025, 2026*

Queen's Graduate Research Fellowship, Queen's University *2025, 2026*

Conference Travel Grant, Queen's University *2026*

Conference Travel Grant, Memorial University of Newfoundland *2025*

School of Graduate Studies Fellowship, Memorial University of Newfoundland *2023–2025*

Second Prize, Asia-wide Essay Competition, Conference on Interaction and Confidence-Building Measures in Asia (CICA) *2024*

Best Paper Award, Bangkok International Student Conference, Thammasat University *2018*

Duke of Edinburgh's International Award, for community service

Conference Presentations and Invited Talks

Discussant and Discussion Lead *July 14–15, 2026*
Reserves at the Ready: Transforming Total Defence Forces in War and Peace, Queen's University, Kingston, Ontario. Co-moderated with Irina Goldenberg and Joakim Berndtsson; organized jointly by CDSN, CSMS, CIDP, and ERGOMAS.

"Exploring Nativism in Canada and India: A Comparative Media Analysis" *June 3, 2025*
Paper presented at the workshop *Internal Migration: Trends, Tensions and Policy Responses*, Canadian Political Science Association Annual Conference, Toronto.

"The Roots of It All: Nativism and Politics" *March 27, 2025*
Panelist at *A Century of Politics & the Next 100 Years*, Department of Political Science, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's.

"Maritime Governance at Bay of Bengal" *February 2025*
Invited talk, National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies (GRIPS), Tokyo, Japan.

"The Political Economy of Chinese Grand Strategy: A Critique of the Neo-Realist Thesis" *2024*
Paper presented at the *PSGSA Graduate Conference*, Department of Political Studies, Queen's University, Canada.

"Assessing Strategic Vulnerabilities in the Bay of Bengal and Their Implications for Bangladesh's Maritime Security" *2020*
Paper presented at the *Seminar on Maritime Domain Awareness*, School of Maritime Warfare and Tactics, Bangladesh Navy.

"ASEAN's Rohingya Dilemma: Limits of Regional Cooperation" *2019*
Paper presented at the *International Conference on the Future of ASEAN (ICoFA)*, UiTM Perlis Branch, Malaysia.

"Rohingya Crisis in the Context of Sino-Indian Geopolitical Competition in Asia" *2019*
Paper presented at the *International Conference on Rohingya: Politics, Ethnic Cleansing and Uncertainty*, Department of Criminology, University of Dhaka.

"One Belt One Road and Regionalization of Asia" *2018*
Paper presented at the *Bangkok International Student Conference*, Faculty of Political Science, Thammasat University. **Best Paper Award.**

Selected Media Appearances

Invited Guest Commentator *June 28, 2026*
Discussion of the Hormuz crisis, *Al-Qahera Channel*.

Invited Guest Commentator *July 2, 2023*
Discussion of South Asian regional politics, *Al-Qahera Channel*.

Reviewer

GeoJournal, Springer

Potentia: Journal of International Affairs

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Saimum, R. (2025). "From Hardware to Heartware: China's Evolving Military Relations with Bangladesh." In C. Xavier & J. T. Jacob (Eds.), *How China Engages South Asia: In the Open and Behind the Scenes* (pp. 107–117). Centre for Social and Economic Progress. Publication link

Shahid, R., & **Saimum, R.** (2023). "Navigating the troubled waters: 'Maritimization' of Bangladesh's foreign policy." *Australian Journal of Maritime & Ocean Affairs*. doi:10.1080/18366503.2023.2228615

Saimum, R., & Talukder, M. A. R. (2022). "The Rohingya Crisis in the Context of Sino-Indian Geopolitical Competition in Myanmar." *Journal of Bangladesh and Global Affairs*, 1(3), December 2022. doi:10.55875/jbga.bd.dec22.005

Saimum, R. (2022). "No Place to Call Home: Historical Context, Statelessness and Contemporary Security Challenges of the Rohingya Refugee Crisis." *BIMRAD Journal*, 3(1), November 2022. Article link

Yasmin, L., **Saimum, R.**, & Ritika, A. K. (2022). "Geopolitics of Confidence and Hope: Assessing the Strategic Significance of the Bay of Bengal and Choices before Bangladesh." BIMRAD. Publication link

Saimum, R. (2020). "The Prospect of Belt and Road Initiative in the Context of Bangladesh." *China Report*, 56(4), 464–483. Sage Publishing. doi:10.1177/0009445520930396

Saimum, R. (2020). "ASEAN's Rohingya Dilemma: Limits of Regional Co-operation." In *Charting a Sustainable Future of ASEAN in Business and Social Sciences* (pp. 339–348). Springer. doi:10.1007/978-981-15-3859-9_29

Manuscripts Under Review and in Preparation

Côté, I., & **Saimum, R.** "Nativism in the News: A Media Analysis of Nativist Discourses in India." *Nationalism and Ethnic Politics*. Revised and resubmitted.

Saimum, R. "Contesting Without Settling: Freedom of Navigation Operations as Geo-Social Diplomacy." In preparation.

Saimum, R. "Narrating the Crisis: India–Pakistan Public Diplomacy from Pahalgam to Operation Sindoor." In preparation.

Selected Policy Articles

1. "Bangladesh's defence diversification and pivot to networked security," *9Dashline* (2026).
2. "Anti-Money Laundering Should Be a Major Pillar of Canada's Indo-Pacific Strategy," *NATO Association of Canada* (2025).
3. "Navigating Indo-Pacific Waters: Maritime Governance and the Case for a Bay of Bengal Coast Guard Forum," *Asia Pacific Bulletin, East-West Center* (2025).
4. "Revolution at Cross-roads: Political Rivalries and Fragile Quest for Democracy in Bangladesh," *Population and Security* (2025).
5. "The Future of Asia We Want: Ideas for the CICA Region," *Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia* (2024).
6. "Steering through Dualities: The Chabahar Port and the Compartmentalization of Indian Foreign Policy," *NATO Association of Canada* (2024).
7. "Testing 'Muddy' Waters: The Geopolitics of 'Teesta' River Water Sharing," *South Asian Futures Fellowship* (2024).
8. "Bangladesh's Strategic Pivot to the Indo-Pacific," *East Asia Forum* (2023).
9. "China's Naval Modernization: The Dragon Going Global?" *Modern Diplomacy* (2021).
10. "Has Modi Conceded 'South Asia' to the United States?" *Modern Diplomacy* (2021).
11. "The Significance of Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV) in Maritime Surveillance and Reconnaissance," BIMRAD (2021).
12. "The Maritime Zones Act 2019: A New Dimension of Blue Economy?" BIMRAD (2020).
13. "How the Rohingya Crisis Destroyed Suu Kyi's Legacy," *Dhaka Tribune* (2019).
14. "Putin's Rollback: Walking in Reagan's Footstep," *International Policy Digest* (2017).
15. "What One Belt One Road Means for Bangladesh," *Dhaka Tribune* (2017).

Software and Tools

R, Stata, NVivo, Power BI, LaTeX

References available upon request.